

Systems

Control Engineering

Course Schedule

1. Systems
2. Continuous-time Controllers
3. Laplace Domain
4. Poles/Zeros & Stability
5. Controller Design
6. Discrete-time Controllers
7. State Space Representation
8. Advanced Control Methods

Systems

- Static and dynamic behavior
- Models
- Proportional systems
- First-order systems
- Second-order systems
- Linear Time-Invariant systems
- Dead time

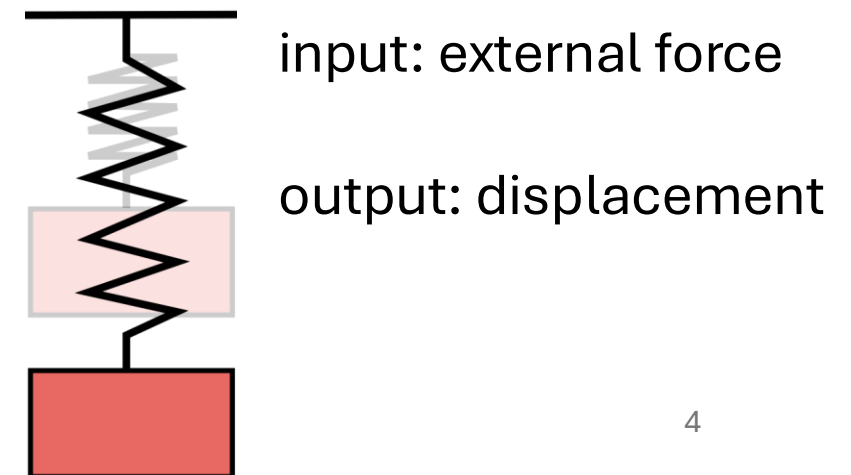
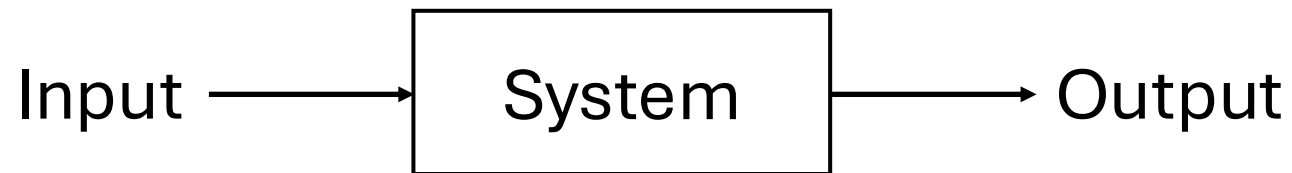
Processes, Systems, Models

Process: the real-world phenomenon (physical, biological, ...), aka plant

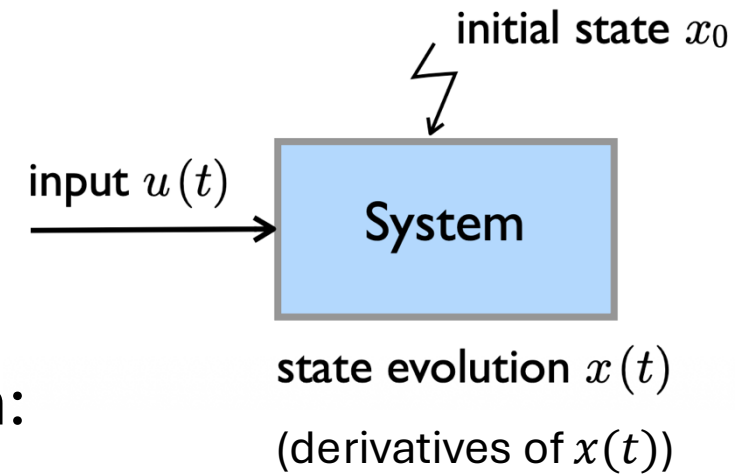
System: abstraction of that process (behavior, dynamics)

Model: mathematical representation of the system

A system maps inputs to outputs (just like processes)



Static and Dynamic Systems



Static system:

Output depends only on the current input, no memory

Time-varying $\neq$ dynamic

Examples:

- Resistor (model: $v = R \cdot i$)
- Valve

Dynamic system:

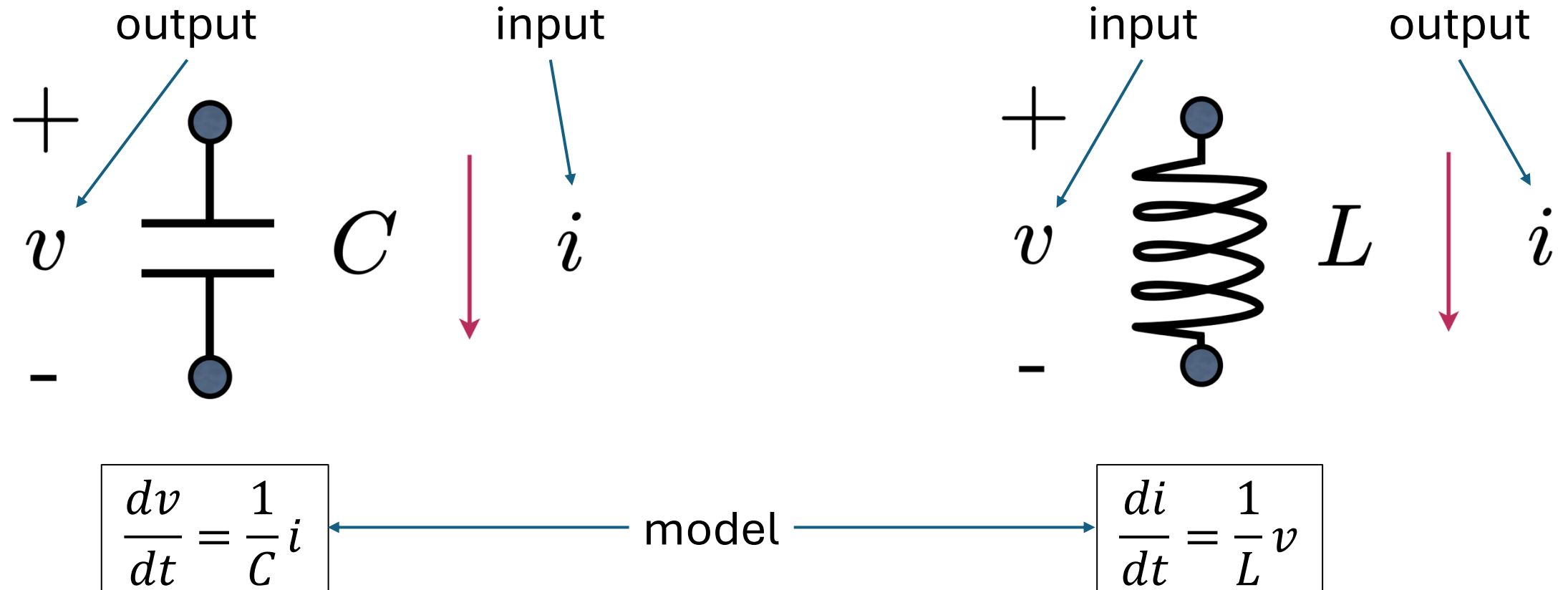
Output depends on input and past states $\rightarrow$ evolves over time

Energy storage $\rightarrow$ memory

Examples:

- Capacitor
- Mass–spring–damper

Examples from Electrical Engineering



Mathematical Models

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = \dot{x}$$

- Algebraic equations (static systems)

$$y(t) = f(u(t), t)$$

A diagram illustrating the relationship between output, input, and time in an algebraic equation. The equation $y(t) = f(u(t), t)$ is shown. A blue arrow points from the word "output" in a box to the variable $y(t)$. Another blue arrow points from the word "input" in a box to the variable $u(t)$.

- Differential equations (dynamic systems)

$$\dot{x}(t) = f(x(t), u(t), t)$$

state variable

A diagram illustrating the relationship between state variable, input, and time in a differential equation. The equation $\dot{x}(t) = f(x(t), u(t), t)$ is shown. A blue arrow points from the word "state variable" in a box to the variable $x(t)$.

- Difference equations (discrete-time systems)

$$x(t + 1) = f(x(t), u(t), t)$$

Define output separately:

$$y = x$$

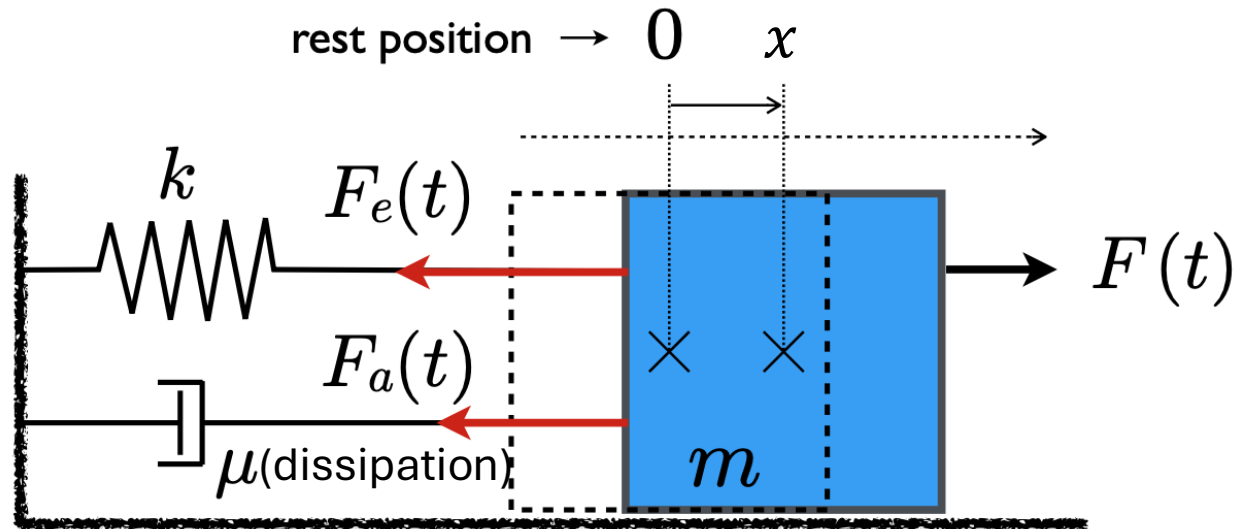
$$y = \dot{x}$$

...

Differential-Equation Models

Describe dynamics using derivatives

Example: mass–spring–damper system



Order of equation = system order

- = number of state variables
- = number of energy storage elements

Newton:

$$ma = F(t) - F_e(t) - F_a(t)$$

→ Model:

$$m\ddot{x} + \mu\dot{x} + kx = F(t)$$

second-order system: energy storages
mass and spring
(even if we choose $y = \dot{x}$, first-order only if we removed the spring)

Why We Need Models

- Predict system behavior
- Design controllers before implementation
- Understand cause-and-effect relationships
- Simplify complex real-world systems

White-, Gray-, and Black-Box Models

	White-Box	Gray-Box	Black-Box
System Knowledge	Full	Partial	None
Parameter Source	Physical	Mixed	Data Only
Interpretability	High	Medium	Low
Effort / Complexity	High	Medium	Low-Medium
Extrapolation	Reliable	Moderate	Poor

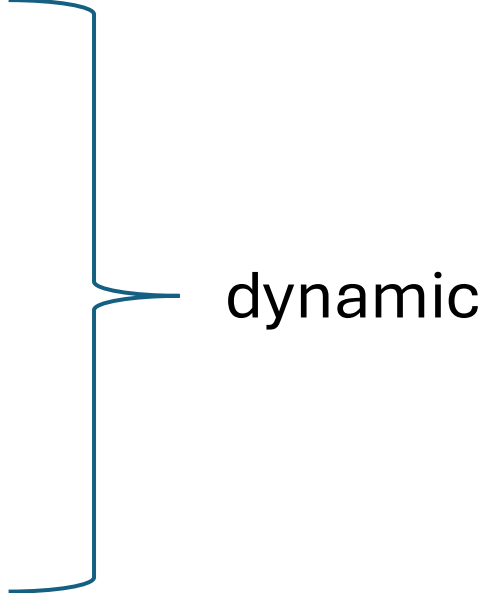
Proportional (P) Systems

- Output proportional to input

$$y(t) = K \cdot u(t)$$

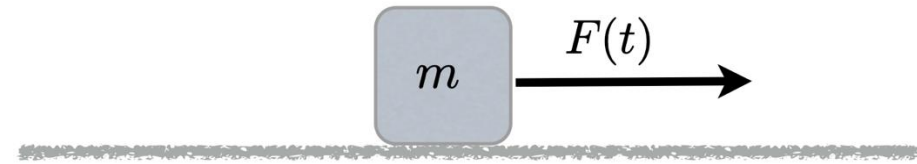

- Static gain (gain = output divided by input), aka DC gain (zero frequency)
- No dynamics
- Examples:
 - Amplifier
 - Resistor: $v(t) = R \cdot i(t)$

Integrating and Differentiating Behavior

- Integrator: $y(t) = \int u(t) dt$
 - Accumulates input over time
 - Introduces memory (energy storage)
 - Differentiator: $y(t) = \frac{d}{dt} u(t)$
 - Responds to rate of change
 - Sensitive to fast variations
- 
- dynamic

Physical systems often contain integrators and differentiators implicitly
→ dynamic behavior (PT1, PT2, ...)

Example: Free Fall



Velocity of a mass subject to a force: $m \cdot \dot{v} = F(t)$

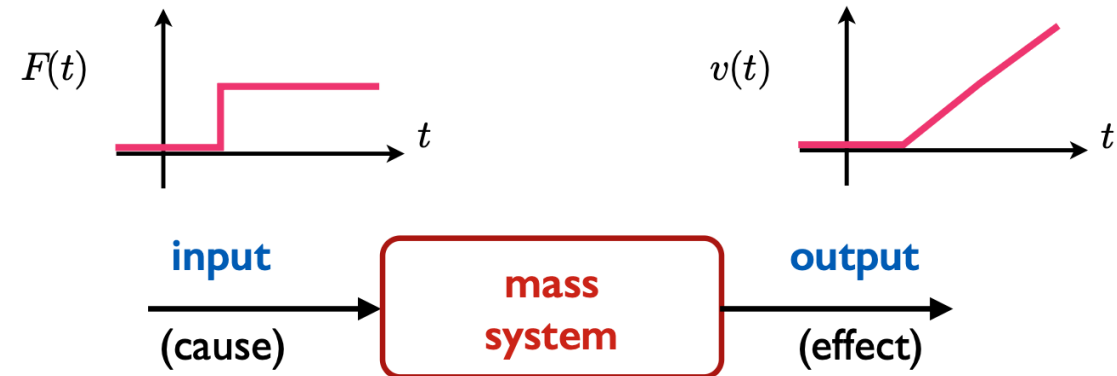
$\dot{v}$ output $F(t)$ input

Freefall: $\dot{v} = g$
 $\swarrow$ earth's acceleration (gravity)

Starting at $t_0 = 0$ with $v_0 = 0$:

$$v = \int_0^t g \, dt = g \cdot t$$

→ grows linearly over time



Real-world: damping due to air resistance ...

First-Order Systems (PT1)

One energy storage element ($\rightarrow 1$)

$$\tau \cdot \dot{y}(t) + y(t) = K \cdot u(t)$$

Two system parameters:

- Time constant $\tau \rightarrow$ dynamic (T)
- Static (DC) gain $K \rightarrow$ proportional (P)

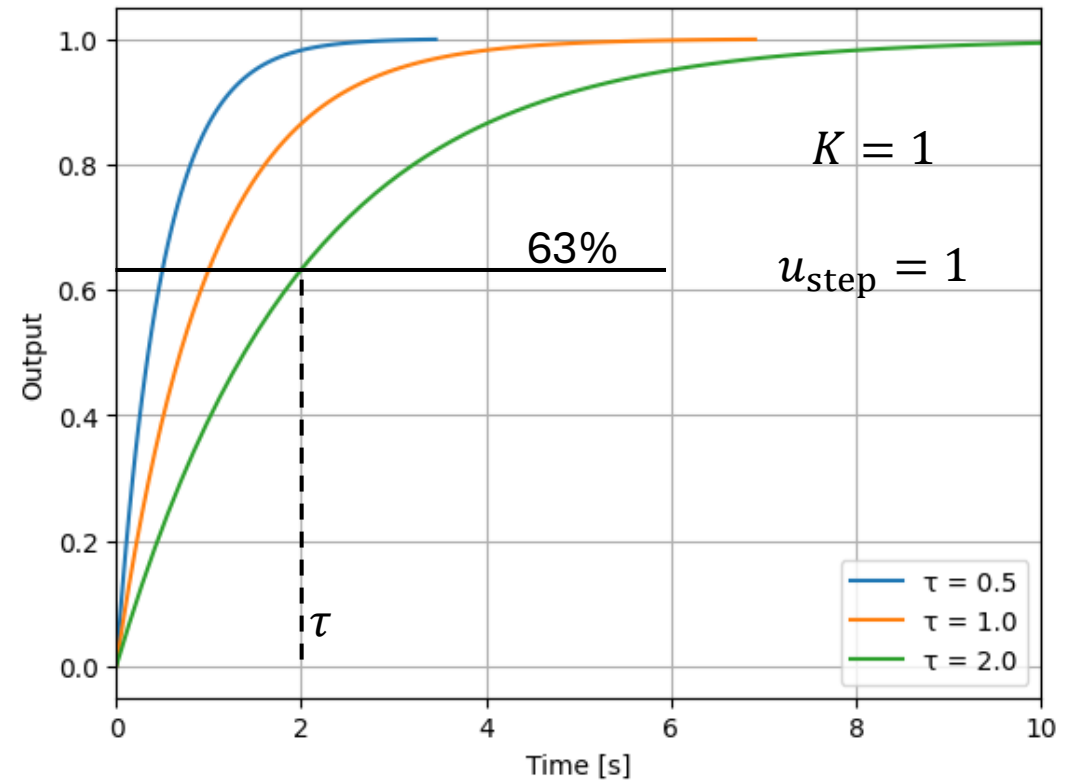
$$K = \frac{y(\infty)}{u_{\text{step}}}$$

output–input ratio for a constant input
after transients have died out, i.e., $\dot{y} = 0$

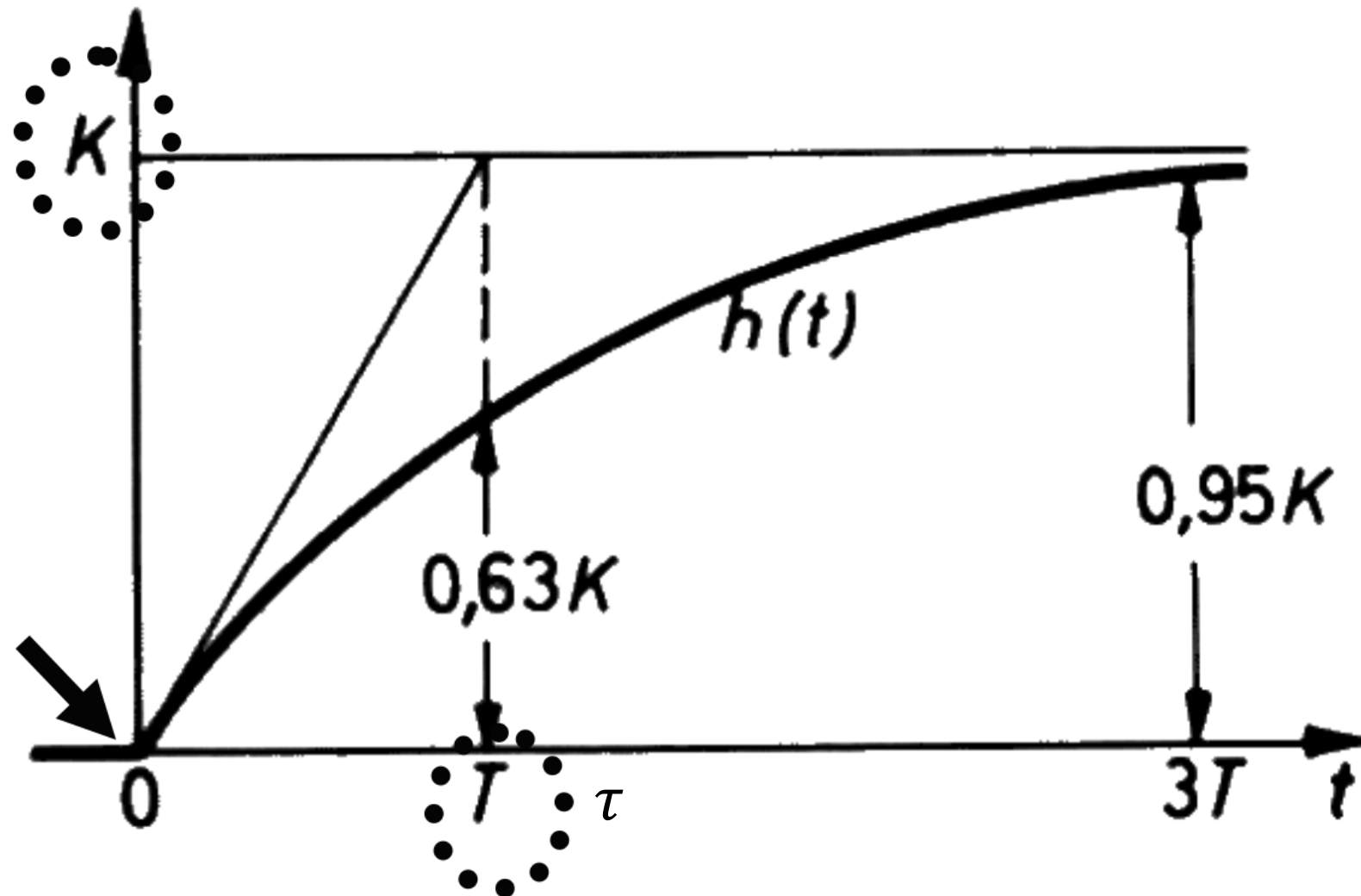
A sudden change of the input signal
to a new constant value, maintained
thereafter:

$$u(t) = \begin{cases} 0, & t < 0 \\ u_{\text{step}}, & t \geq 0 \end{cases}$$

Step response:



Gain and Time Constant



Solution for PT1 Differential Equation

Unforced (natural): $\tau \cdot \dot{y}(t) + y(t) = 0$

$$y(t) = C \cdot e^{-t/\tau}$$

defined by initial conditions

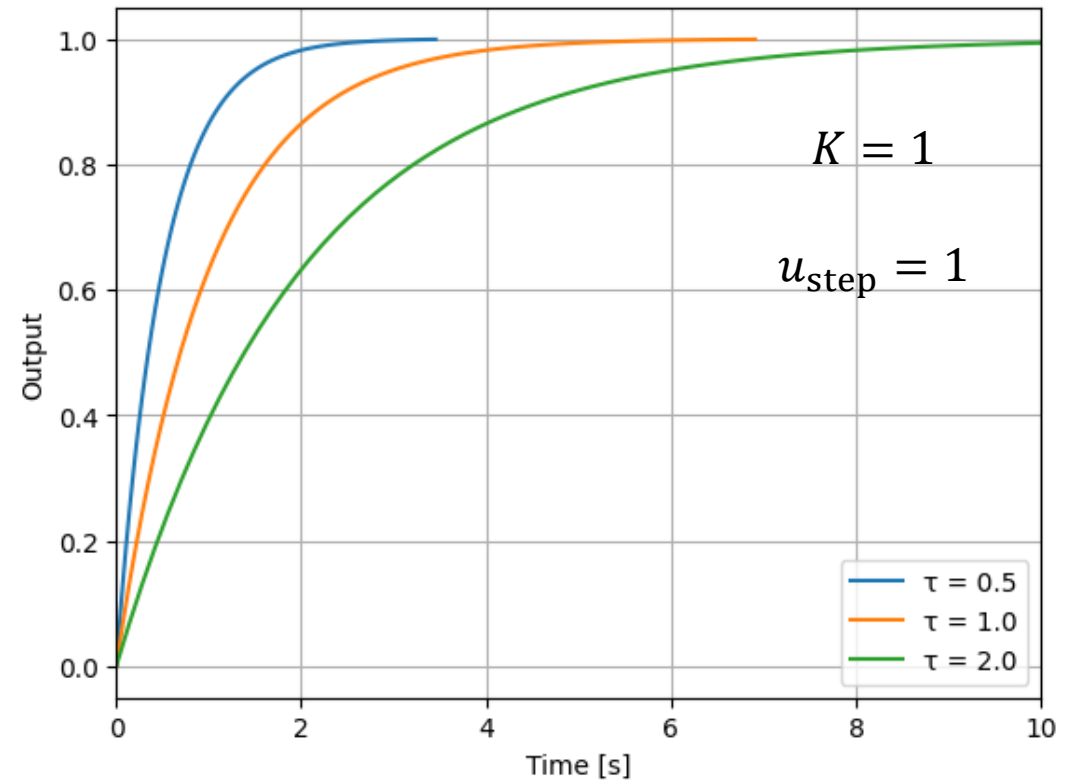
Forced: $\tau \cdot \dot{y}(t) + y(t) = K \cdot u(t)$

Example:

- At $t = 0$, step from $u = 0$ to $u = u_{\text{step}}$
- Initial condition $y(0) = 0$

$$y(t) = K \cdot u_{\text{step}} \cdot (1 - e^{-t/\tau})$$

Step response:



Derivation of Specific Example

Total response = forced (particular) response + natural (homogeneous) response

$$y(t) = y_p + C \cdot e^{-t/\tau}$$

Particular response: constant input (u_{step}) $\rightarrow$ constant solution y_p

$$0 + y_p = K \cdot u_{\text{step}}$$

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = K \cdot u_{\text{step}} + C \cdot e^{-t/\tau}$$

Determine C from initial condition ($y(0) = 0$)

$$0 = K \cdot u_{\text{step}} + C \cdot e^{-0/\tau}$$

$$\Rightarrow C = -K \cdot u_{\text{step}}$$

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = K \cdot u_{\text{step}} \cdot (1 - e^{-t/\tau})$$

Free Fall with Viscous Damping

Account for air resistance:

$$m \cdot \dot{v} = m \cdot g - c \cdot v$$

damping coefficient

→ PT1 differential equation:

$$\frac{m}{c} \cdot \dot{v} + v = \frac{m}{c} \cdot g$$

$$\tau = \frac{m}{c} \quad K = \frac{m}{c}$$

Viscous damping is a *simplified model*. In reality, aerodynamic drag is typically quadratic in velocity. Linear damping is a good approximation for small velocities or near an operating point.

Example: RC and RL Circuits

Transient responses to switching

Capacitor: $\frac{dv}{dt} = \frac{1}{C} i$

Inductor: $\frac{di}{dt} = \frac{1}{L} v$

But circuits without R are not physically realizable (e.g., charging a capacitor would require infinite current)

→ damping

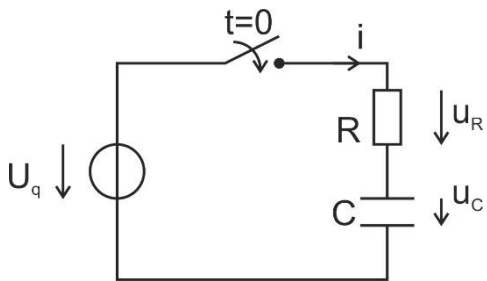
Transient Responses: RC Series Circuit

Differential equation:

$$R \cdot i + u_C = U_q$$
$$\rightarrow \underbrace{R \cdot C}_{\tau = RC} \cdot \dot{u}_C + u_C = U_q$$

$\tau = RC$ $K = 1$
system parameters

Charging the capacitor with DC:

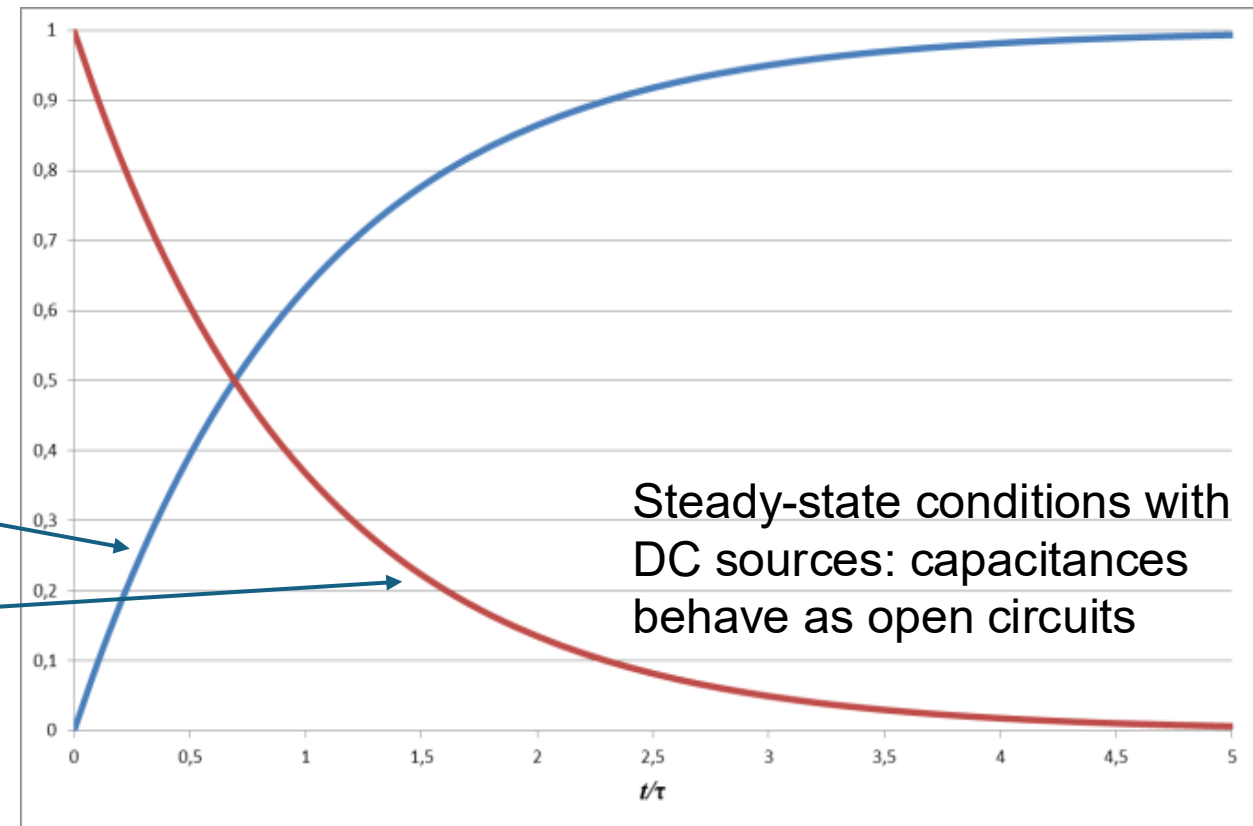


$$u_C = U_q \left(1 - e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}\right)$$

$$i = C \cdot \dot{u}_C = \frac{U_q}{R} \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$

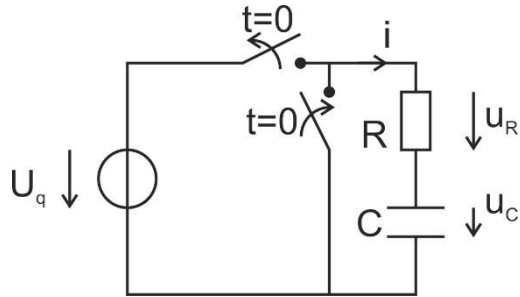
$$u_R = R \cdot i = U_q \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$

Transients: time-varying currents and voltages resulting from the sudden application of sources (usually due to switching)



Transient Responses: RC Series Circuit

Discharging the capacitor:



Differential equation:

$$R \cdot C \cdot \dot{u}_C + u_C = 0$$

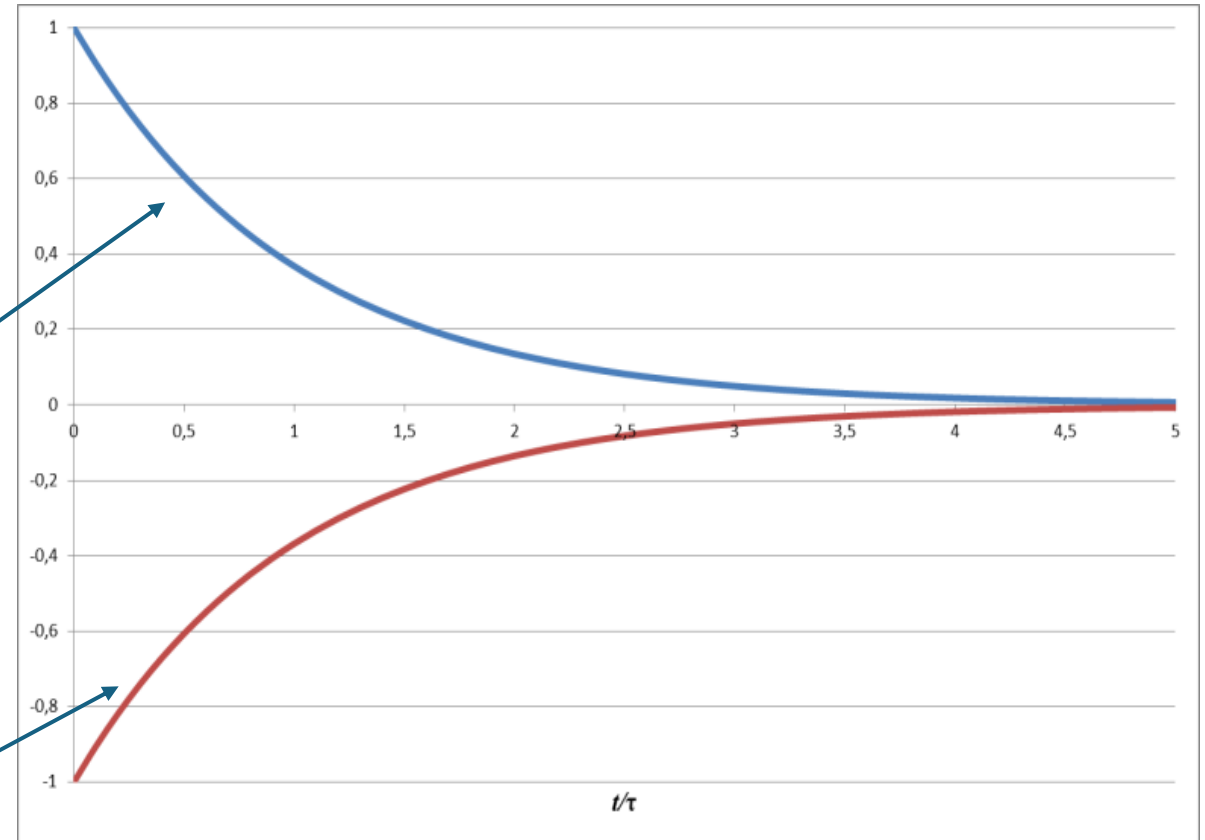
$$\tau = RC$$

$$u_C = U_q \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$

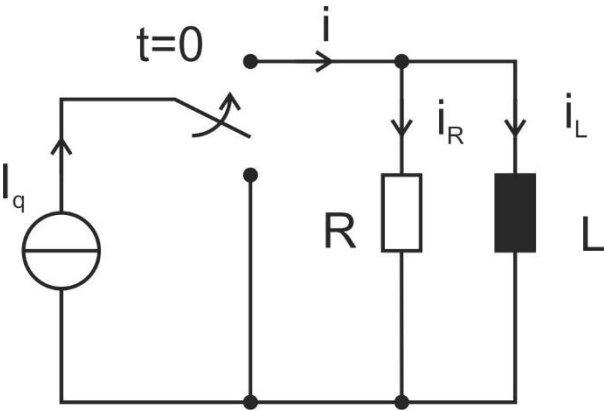
$u_C(0)$

$$i = -\frac{U_q}{R} \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$

$C \cdot \dot{u}_C$



Transient Responses: RL Parallel Circuit



$$i_R + i_L = I_q$$

$$\rightarrow \frac{u}{R} + i_L = I_q$$

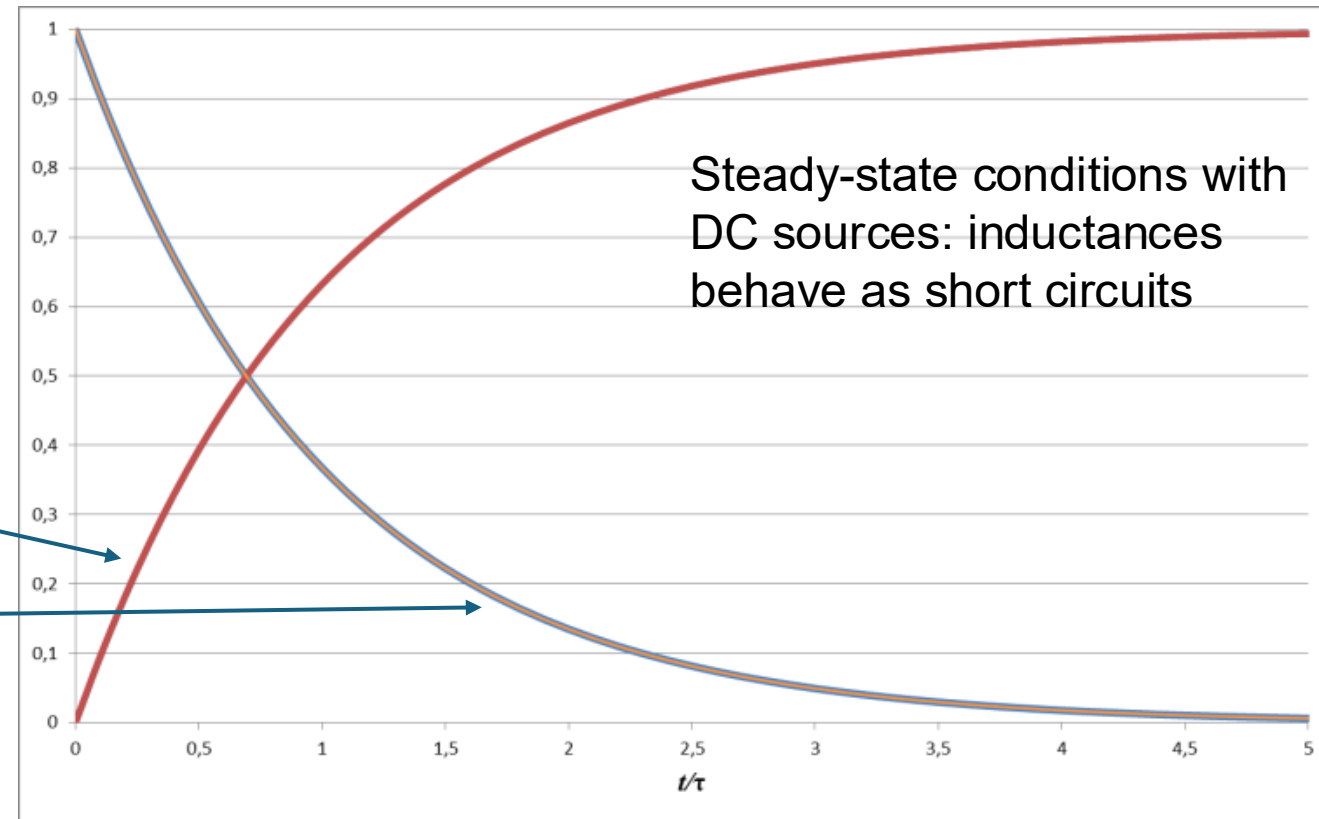
$$\rightarrow \frac{L}{R} \cdot \frac{di_L}{dt} + i_L = I_q$$

$$\tau = \frac{L}{R}$$

$$i_L = I_q (1 - e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}})$$

$$u = L \cdot \frac{di_L}{dt} = I_q \cdot R \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$

$$i_R = I_q - i_L = I_q \cdot e^{-\frac{t}{\tau}}$$



Series connection of two PT1:
Time constants determine behavior

Second-Order Systems (PT2)

Two energy storage elements ($\rightarrow 2$)

$$\ddot{y} + 2\zeta\omega_n\dot{y} + \omega_n^2y = \omega_n^2Ku$$

Three system parameters:

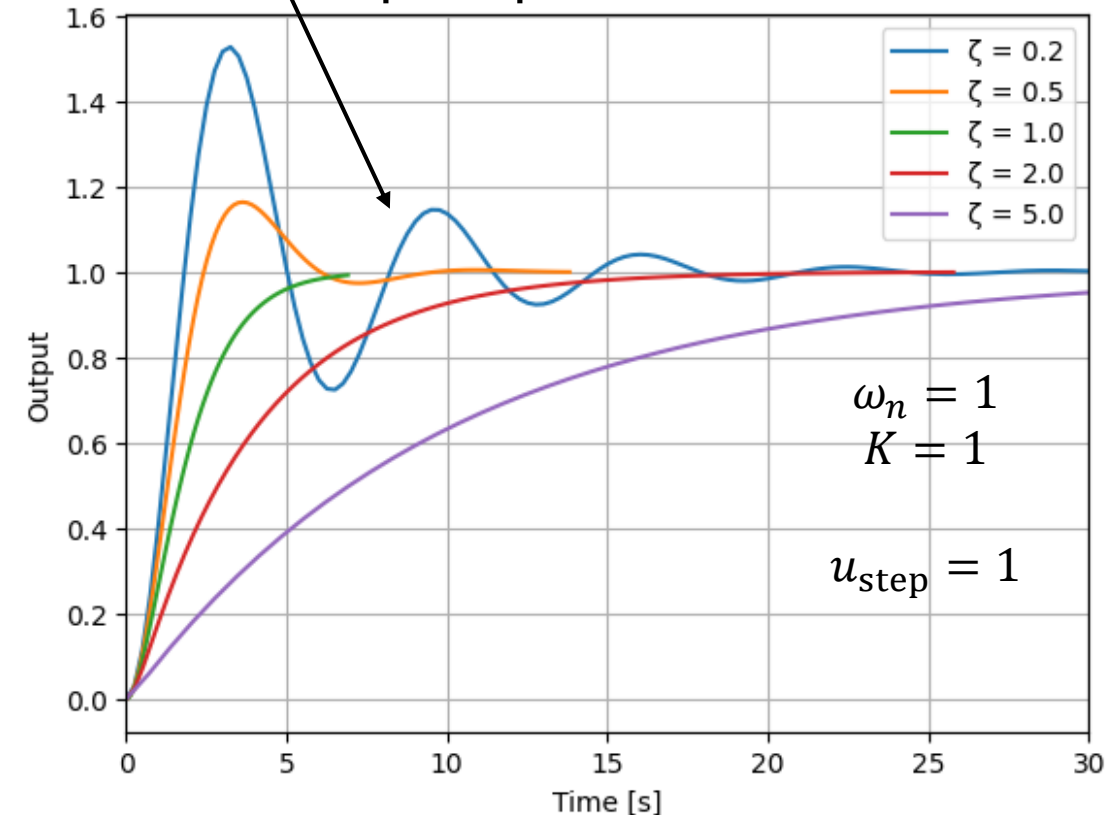
- Natural frequency ω_n
- Damping ratio ζ
- Static (DC) gain (as in PT1): $K = \frac{y(\infty)}{u_{\text{step}}}$

Different cases:

- Underdamped ($\zeta < 1$)
 - Critically damped ($\zeta = 1$)
 - Overdamped ($\zeta > 1$)
- } no oscillation

can show oscillations

Step response:



Solution for PT2 Differential Equation

Unforced (natural): $\ddot{y} + 2\zeta\omega_n\dot{y} + \omega_n^2y = 0$

$$\zeta < 1: y(t) = e^{-\zeta\omega_n t} \left(C_1 \cos(\sqrt{1-\zeta^2}\omega_n t) + C_2 \sin(\sqrt{1-\zeta^2}\omega_n t) \right)$$

$$\zeta = 1: y(t) = (C_1 + C_2 t)e^{-\omega_n t}$$

$$\zeta > 1: y(t) = C_1 e^{s_1 t} + C_2 e^{s_2 t} \quad \text{with} \quad s_{1,2} = -\zeta\omega_n \pm \omega_n \sqrt{\zeta^2 - 1}$$

Forced: $\ddot{y} + 2\zeta\omega_n\dot{y} + \omega_n^2y = \omega_n^2 K u$

Example:

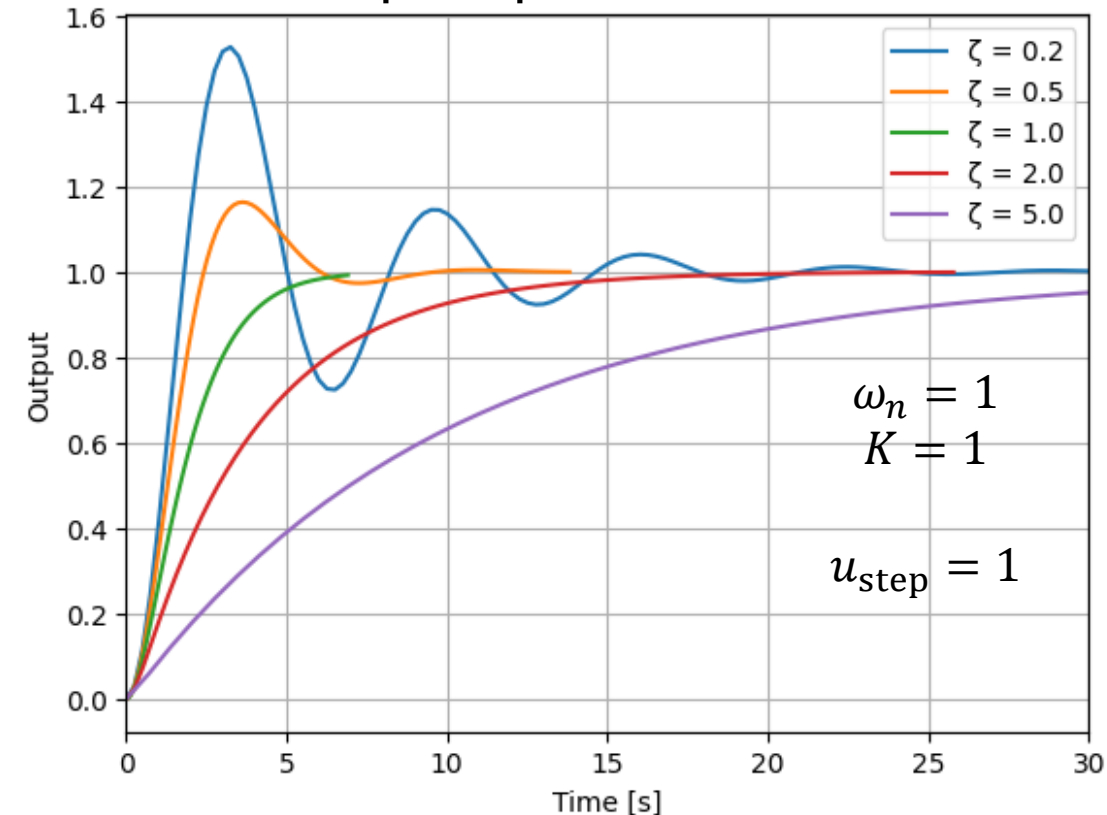
- At $t = 0$, step from $u = 0$ to $u = 1$
- Initial conditions $y(0) = 0, \dot{y}(0) = 0$

$$\zeta < 1: y(t) = K \left[1 - e^{-\zeta\omega_n t} \left(\cos(\sqrt{1-\zeta^2}\omega_n t) + \frac{\zeta}{\sqrt{1-\zeta^2}} \sin(\sqrt{1-\zeta^2}\omega_n t) \right) \right]$$

$$\zeta = 1: y(t) = K[1 - (1 + \omega_n t)e^{-\omega_n t}]$$

$$\zeta > 1: y(t) = K \left[1 + \frac{s_2}{s_1 - s_2} e^{s_1 t} - \frac{s_1}{s_1 - s_2} e^{s_2 t} \right]$$

Step response:



Derivation of Specific Example

Particular response: constant input ($u_{\text{step}} = 1$) $\rightarrow$ constant solution y_p

$$0 + 0 + \omega_n^2 y_p = \omega_n^2 \cdot K \cdot 1$$
$$\Rightarrow y_p = K$$

$\zeta < 1$:

Total response = forced (particular) response + natural (homogeneous) response

$$y(t) = K + e^{-\zeta \omega_n t} \left(C_1 \cos(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) + C_2 \sin(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) \right)$$

Determine C_1 and C_2 from initial conditions ($y(0) = 0$, $\dot{y}(0) = 0$)

$$0 = K + 1 \cdot (C_1 \cdot 1 + C_2 \cdot 0) \Rightarrow C_1 = -K$$

$$\dot{y}(t) = e^{-\zeta \omega_n t} \left[-\zeta \omega_n (C_1 \cos + C_2 \sin) - \sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n C_1 \sin + \sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n C_2 \cos \right]$$

$$0 = 1 \cdot \left[-\zeta \omega_n (C_1 + 0) - 0 + \sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n C_2 \right] \Rightarrow C_2 = \frac{\zeta \omega_n C_1}{\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n} = -\frac{\zeta K}{\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2}}$$

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = K + e^{-\zeta \omega_n t} \left(-K \cos(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) - \frac{\zeta K}{\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2}} \sin(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) \right) =$$

$$K \left[1 - e^{-\zeta \omega_n t} \left(\cos(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) + \frac{\zeta}{\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2}} \sin(\sqrt{1 - \zeta^2} \omega_n t) \right) \right]$$

$\zeta = 1$:

Total response = forced (particular) response + natural (homogeneous) response

$$y(t) = K + (C_1 + C_2 t)e^{-\omega_n t}$$

Determine C_1 and C_2 from initial conditions ($y(0) = 0, \dot{y}(0) = 0$)

$$0 = K + (C_1 + C_2 \cdot 0) \cdot 1 \Rightarrow C_1 = -K$$

$$\dot{y}(t) = -C_1 \cdot e^{-\omega_n t} \cdot \omega_n - C_2 \cdot e^{-\omega_n t} \cdot \omega_n \cdot t + C_2 \cdot e^{-\omega_n t}$$

$$0 = -C_1 \cdot \omega_n - 0 + C_2 \Rightarrow C_2 = C_1 \cdot \omega_n = -K \cdot \omega_n$$

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = K + (-K - K\omega_n t)e^{-\omega_n t} = K[1 - (1 + \omega_n t)e^{-\omega_n t}]$$

$\zeta > 1$:

Total response = forced (particular) response + natural (homogeneous) response

$$y(t) = K + C_1 e^{s_1 t} + C_2 e^{s_2 t}$$

Determine C_1 and C_2 from initial conditions ($y(0) = 0, \dot{y}(0) = 0$)

$$0 = K + C_1 + C_2$$

$$\dot{y}(t) = s_1 \cdot C_1 e^{s_1 t} + s_2 \cdot C_2 e^{s_2 t}$$

$$0 = s_1 \cdot C_1 + s_2 \cdot C_2$$

$$\Rightarrow C_1 = -\frac{s_2 \cdot C_2}{s_1} = \frac{s_2 \cdot K + s_2 \cdot C_1}{s_1} \Rightarrow C_1 - \frac{s_2 \cdot C_1}{s_1} = \frac{s_2 \cdot K}{s_1} \Rightarrow C_1 = \frac{s_2 \cdot K}{s_1} / \left(1 - \frac{s_2}{s_1}\right) = \frac{s_2 \cdot K}{s_1 - s_2}$$

$$\Rightarrow C_2 = -K - \frac{s_2 \cdot K}{s_1 - s_2}$$

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = K + K \frac{s_2}{s_1 - s_2} e^{s_1 t} - K \left(1 + \frac{s_2}{s_1 - s_2}\right) e^{s_2 t} = K \left[1 + \frac{s_2}{s_1 - s_2} e^{s_1 t} - \frac{s_1}{s_1 - s_2} e^{s_2 t}\right]$$

Example: Mass-Spring-Damper

$$m\ddot{x} + \mu\dot{x} + kx = F(t)$$

$$\omega_n = \sqrt{\frac{k}{m}}$$

$$\zeta = \frac{\mu}{2m\omega_n} = \frac{\mu}{2\sqrt{km}}$$

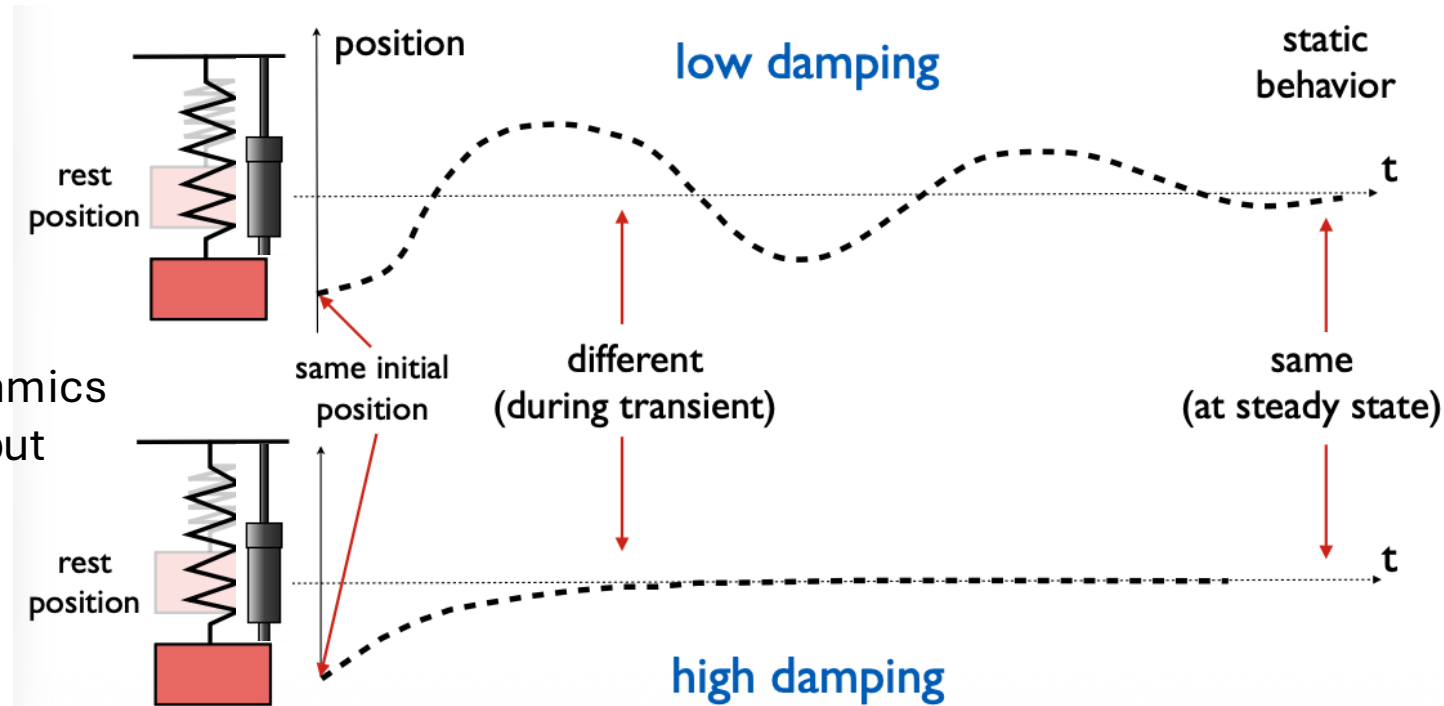
At steady state:

$$\ddot{x} = 0, \dot{x} = 0 \Rightarrow kx(\infty) = F(\infty)$$

$$K = \frac{x(\infty)}{F(\infty)} = \frac{1}{k}$$

(for step input)

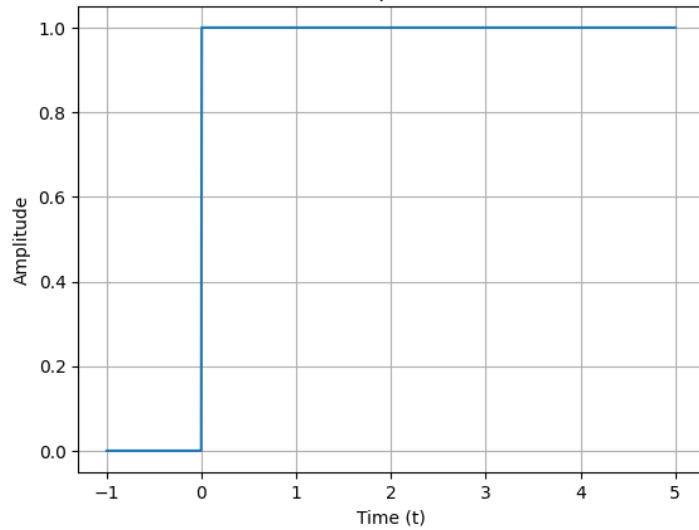
impulse:
same dynamics
as step input



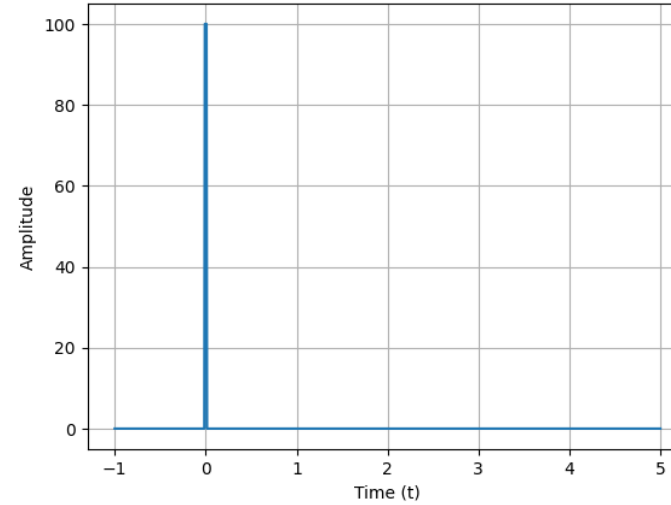
without damping ($\zeta = 0$): $y(t) = A \cdot \cos(\omega_n t + \phi)$

Step and Impulse Response

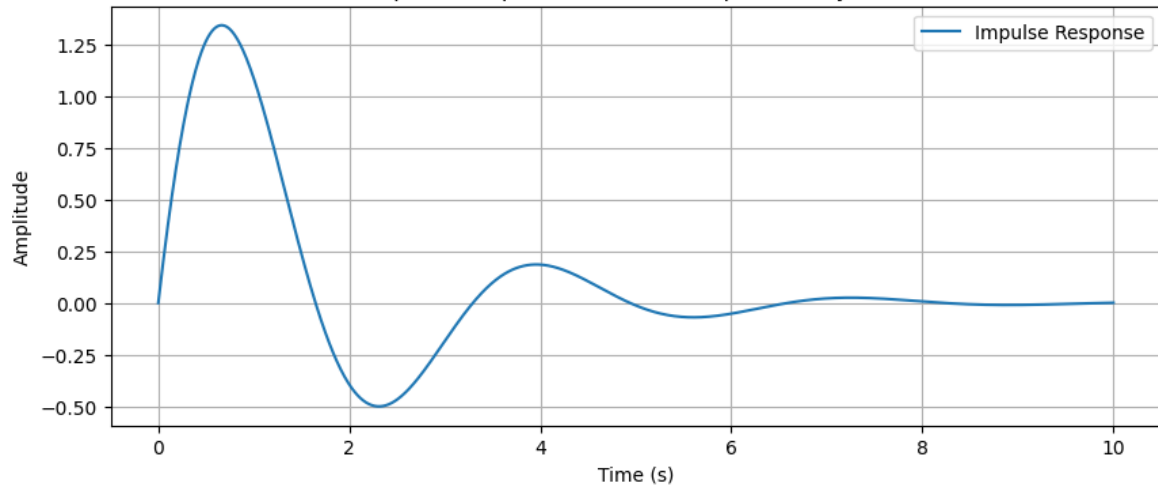
Unit Step Function



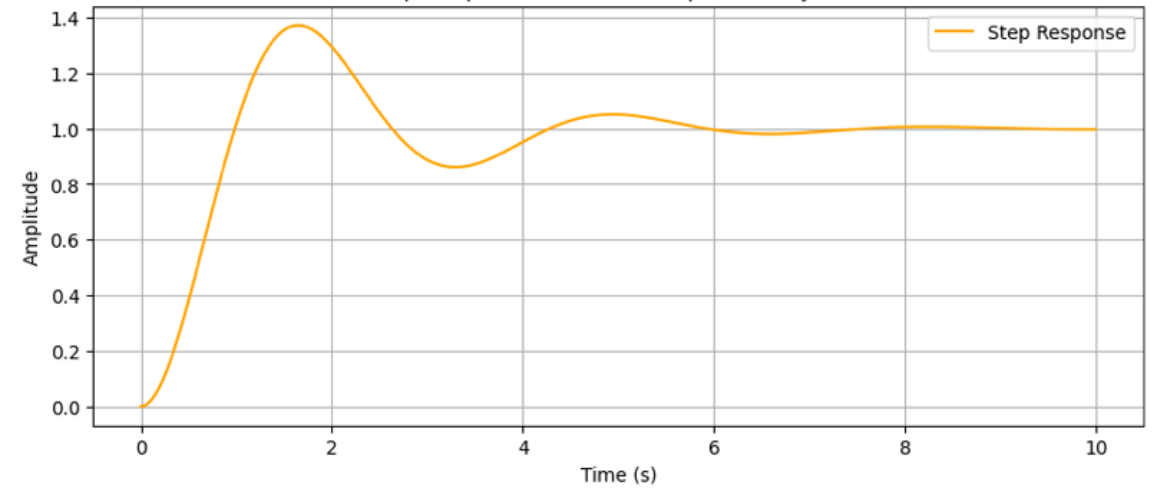
Impulse Function (Approximation of Dirac Delta)



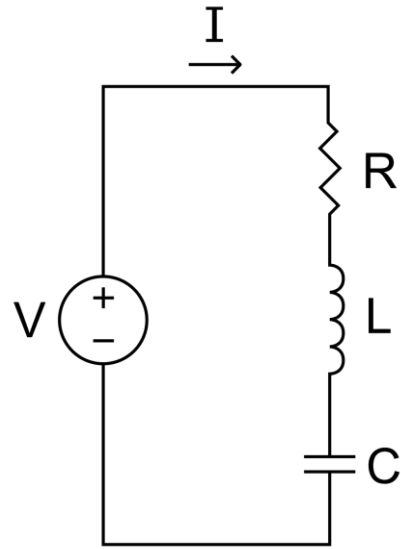
Impulse Response of Underdamped PT2 System



Step Response of Underdamped PT2 System



Example: RLC Series Circuit



$$LC\ddot{v}_C + RC\dot{v}_C + v_C = u(t)$$

step voltage input

output: capacitor voltage

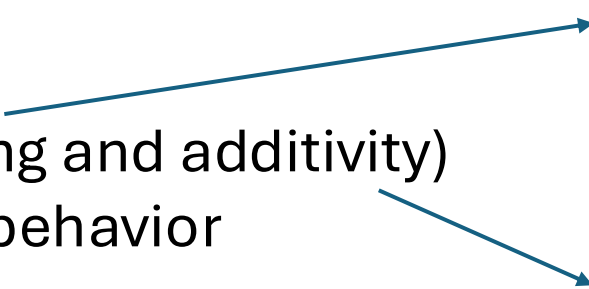
$$\omega_n = \sqrt{\frac{1}{LC}}, \quad \zeta = \frac{R}{2} \sqrt{\frac{C}{L}}, \quad K = 1$$

- Without R : undamped
- An RLC circuit is a PT2 system whose step response is governed by natural frequency and damping, exactly like a mass–spring–damper system.
- Frequency response (resonance) describes sinusoidal forcing. Here we focus on step response and transient behavior.

Linear Time-Invariant (LTI) Systems

What do PT1 and PT2 have in common?

- Linear equations
- Constant parameters
- Superposition holds (scaling and additivity)
- Time shifts do not change behavior


$$\begin{aligned} u(t) &\rightarrow y(t) \\ \Rightarrow a \cdot u(t) &\rightarrow a \cdot y(t) \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} u_1(t) &\rightarrow y_1(t), \quad u_2(t) \rightarrow y_2(t) \\ \Rightarrow u_1(t) + u_2(t) &\rightarrow y_1(t) + y_2(t) \end{aligned}$$

→ LTI systems

- Governed by linear differential equations
- Parameters do not depend on time

Foundation of classical control theory

Dead Time

Time delay between input and output:

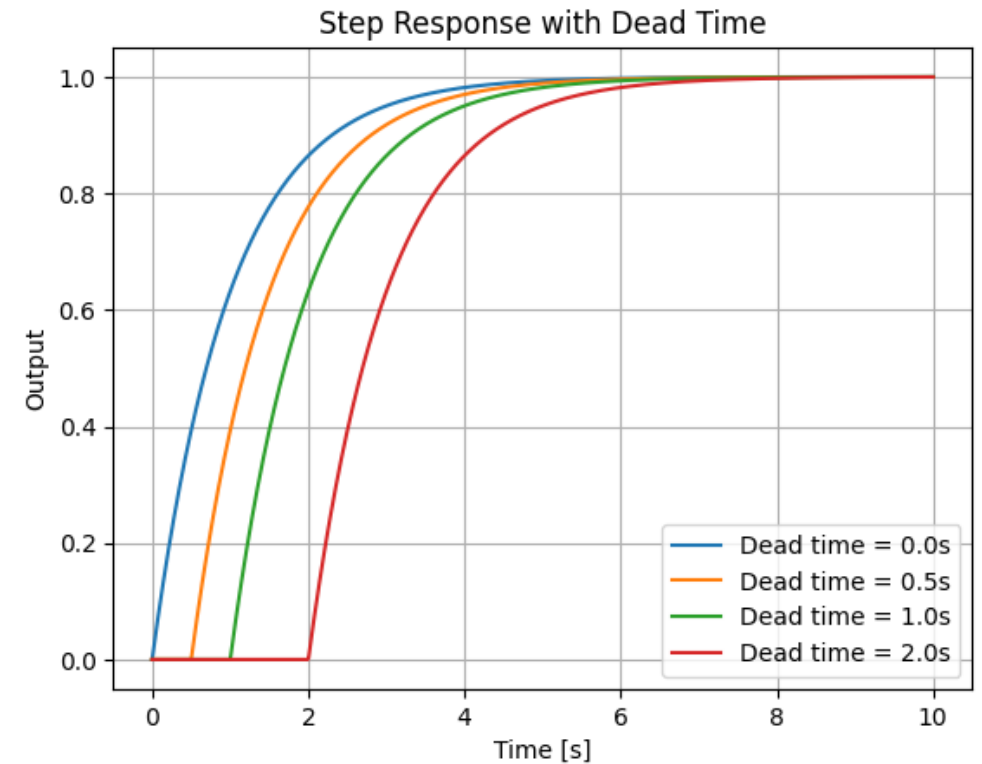
$$y(t) = u(t - \tau_d)$$

Common in processes and networks

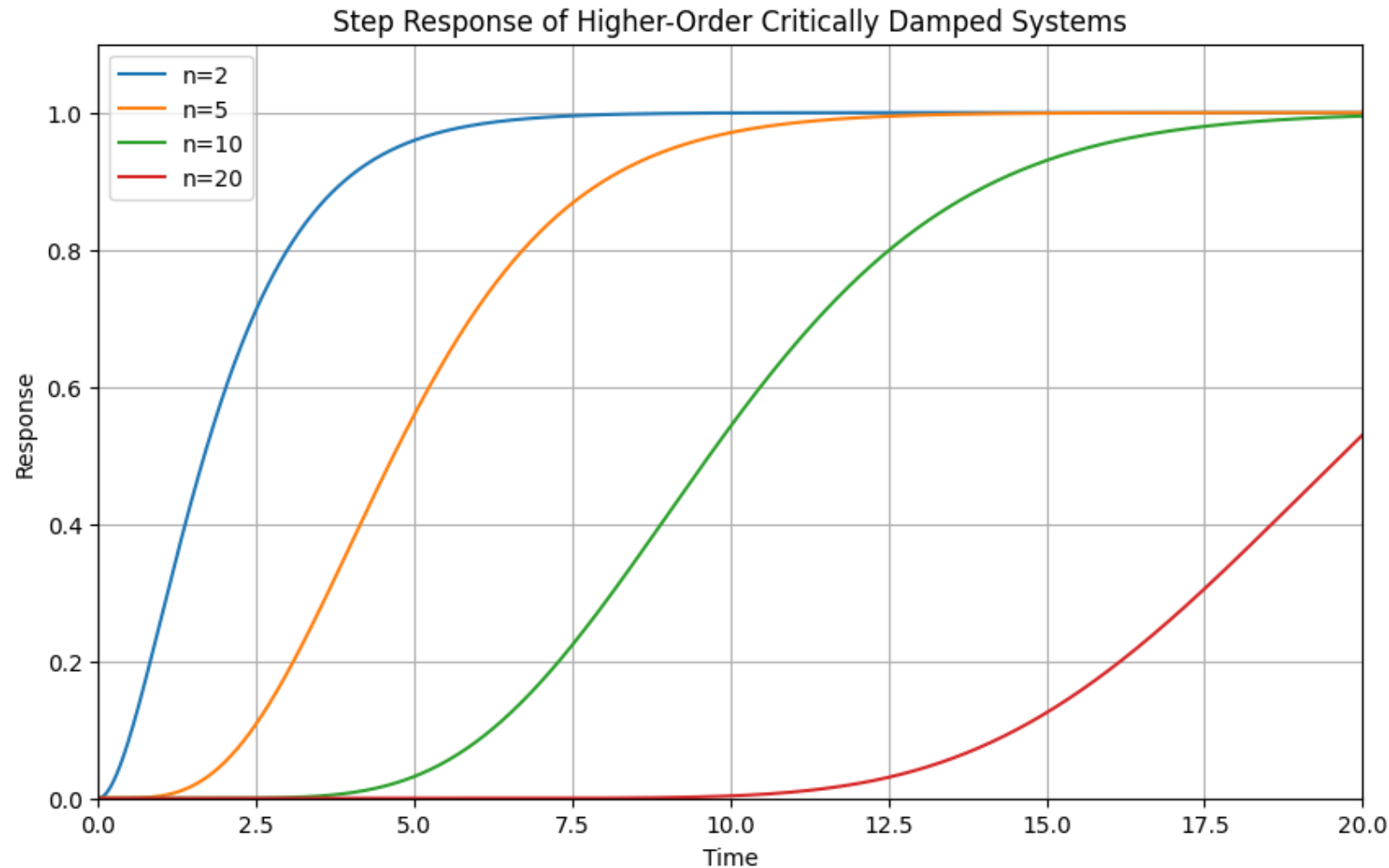
- Transport phenomena
- Measurement delays
- Computation delays

Makes control more difficult

- Degrades stability margins
- Limits achievable performance



Step Responses of Higher-Order Systems



The higher the order, the more the step response looks like a delayed step, even though there's no actual dead time.

Outlook: Frequency Response

So far, we tested systems with steps.

What if the input oscillates?

- slow sinusoid $\rightarrow$ output follows
- fast sinusoid $\rightarrow$ output attenuated / phase-shifted

Summary: From Physics to Model

- Identify inputs and outputs
- Apply physical laws
- Simplify assumptions
- Validate against measurements

Exercise 1

A system is described by the following relation:

$$y(t) = 2 u(t)$$

- Is this system static or dynamic?
- What is the output for a step input $u(t) = 3$?

Exercise 2

A proportional system has gain $K = 4$.

- Write the input-output relation.
- Compute the output for $u(t) = 1.5$.

Exercise 3

Consider a first-order system with $T = 2$, $K = 3$, and step input $u(t) = 1$.

- Write the differential equation.
- Determine the steady-state value.

Exercise 4

Given the model:

$$\dot{y}(t) = -2 y(t) + 2 u(t)$$

- Is this a first-order system?
- What happens if $u(t) = 0$?

Exercise 5

Consider the system

$$\ddot{y}(t) + 6 \dot{y}(t) + 9 y(t) = 9 u(t)$$

with step input $u(t) = 1$ and initial conditions $y(0) = 0$, $\dot{y}(0) = 0$.

- Determine whether the system is underdamped, critically damped, or overdamped.
- Determine the steady-state value y_{∞} .
- Describe qualitatively the shape of the step response.

Exercise 6

Consider the system:

$$\ddot{y}(t) + 2 \dot{y}(t) + 5 y(t) = 5 u(t)$$

with step input $u(t) = 1$.

- Determine ω_n and ζ .
- Classify the damping behavior.
- Will the system overshoot?
- Determine the steady-state value.